

Parks Department Meeting September 16th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GjGx8KOUzA0
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Park and Recreation Board

Meeting Date: September 16, 2025

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee work session held immediately prior to the regular meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Muncie Park and Recreation Board meeting to order on September 16, 2025, initiating the session with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:29](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** James Lutton, Mark Irvin, Shannon Powers, Brad Marshall [00:01:00](#).
 - **Members Absent:** Shandra (noted by the board as having an excused family commitment) [00:01:09](#).

- **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall (implied via meeting direction).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:37](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the August meeting were approved by voice vote with no discussions or revisions [00:01:21](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:40](#) **Superintendent Report: Carl Malone**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Highlighted the upcoming Indiana IP conference hosted locally and encouraged board attendance.
 - Extended a major shout-out to Matt Cox and the IU Health volunteer team for beautifying Alshshire, Thomas, and Westside parks on Friday, which included painting basketball courts, playground equipment, and storage sheds, alongside donating picnic tables and planter boxes [00:02:32](#).
 - Noted staff attendance at the state conference focusing on programming, with four parks on display: Perry Creek Reservoir educational center, Westside skate park, Store Estates Park, and Riverview park design [00:04:18](#).
 - Pool operations: Twining Pool scheduled for draining on the 19th and winterization on the 23rd [00:05:08](#). YMCA has removed concession equipment and returned keys [00:05:32](#).
 - Addressed recent water leaks and drainage troubleshooting at McCulloch Park and the Buie Center, assisted by JBird and sewer maintenance [00:05:56](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.
- [00:09:07](#) **Update on Legal Graffiti Wall Project: Caleb Schwarz**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Caleb Schwarz, Community Advocate.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided an update on fundraising, community surveys, and securing letters of support (Muncie Arts and Culture Council, Hunger Skate Parks, Mayor's office, etc.) for a legal graffiti wall at Westside Skate Park. Scheduled a pre-grant Zoom meeting with the George and Francis Ball Foundation (GFBF) on October 20th for a potential \$10,000 grant. The board and superintendent discussed youth engagement targets and school partnerships.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal board action required.
- [00:24:48](#) **Event Approval: Juneteenth Celebration**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone / Staff.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Annual request to secure date and equipment (cabin bleachers, large stage tent, porta-potties, horses, trash cans totaling \$882) for the Juneteenth event hosted by Legacy Life Security at McCulloch Park.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:27:16](#).
- **00:27:29 Event Approval: Heekin Park Open Men's Basketball Tournament**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Zion Strong, Zion Strong Organization / Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of the successful past summer tournament and request for approval for the "Summer Showdown" basketball tournament and entertainment event at Heekin Park scheduled for July 23-26, 2026. Also touched on the upcoming 6-week winter league at the Boys and Girls Club and the proposed renaming of a Muncie Housing Authority park to Marwan Strong Park.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Zion Strong spoke regarding event security, professional athletes, and entertainment aspects [00:28:42](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:32:45](#).
- **00:33:08 Event Approval: JLG Memory Walk (5K)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Devon Mitchell, Grateful Pathways / Deliverance Temple.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to host a 5K memory walk at McCulloch Park on October 11, 2025, from 9:00 a.m. to noon to honor suicide prevention and remember local youth. No vendors or fees requested.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Devon Mitchell presented background details on the memorial walk [00:34:43](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:35:48](#).
- **00:38:00 Prairie Creek Report & Event Approvals: Misty Reigns**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Misty Reigns, Interim Operations Manager.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided updates on end-of-season mowing reallocation, cabin/shelter TLC, dock removal, IDEM/IDOH inspections, and the implementation of Northshore Campground bathroom security/locks.
 - **Event Approvals (Prairie Creek):**
 - *Prairie Creek Catfish Club Tournament* (September 27, 2025, 6:00 a.m. - 2:00 p.m.) Approved by Voice Vote [00:42:47](#).
 - *Delaware County Jeep Club Movie Night* (September 27, 2025, 8:00 p.m.) Approved by Voice Vote [00:44:30](#).
 - *Friends of Prairie Creek Halloween Bash* (October 18, 2025, 5:00 p.m. - 10:00 p.m.) Approved by Voice Vote [00:46:28](#).
 - *Ruble Racing Triathlons* (May 17, 2026, and September 27, 2026) Approved by Voice Vote [00:51:30](#) (noting adjustments to align with updated 2026 pricing).
- **01:15:36 Multi-Use Trails at Prairie Creek (Old Business)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** David (Flatland Resources) / Board.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding the formal approval received from the American Water Company for multi-use trail extensions funded by an 80% DNR matching grant (\$260,000) and a Ball Foundation match (\$40,000). Board members raised concerns regarding long-term maintenance costs and past trail closures.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for a future vote pending a formal presentation and maintenance review [01:24:08](#).
- [01:26:41](#) **Prairie Creek Rate Review (Old Business)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members and Misty Reigns.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Comprehensive review and adjustment of rates across Prairie Creek operations to offset attrition and rising operational costs.
 - **Actions & Votes (Roll Call Votes where explicitly conducted):**
 - *Daily & Annual Launch Fees:* Approved daily rate of \$30, annual rate of \$200, and boater education rate of \$150 via Roll Call (James Lutton - Yes, Mark Irvin - Yes, Shannon Powers - No, Brad Marshall - Yes) [01:39:39](#).
 - *Public & Wood Dock Fees:* Approved public dock fee at \$600 with an annual launch fee factor (totaling \$680) via Roll Call (James Lutton - Yes, Mark Irvin - Yes, Shannon Powers - Yes, Brad Marshall - Yes) [01:42:36](#).
 - *Sailboat Club Dock Fees:* Approved sailboat club dock fee at \$560 (removing separate launch fee) via Roll Call (James Lutton - Yes, Mark Irvin - Yes, Shannon Powers - Yes, Brad Marshall - Yes) [02:00:42](#).
 - *Seasonal Camping Electrical Surcharge:* Approved adding a \$200 electrical surcharge to the existing \$1,450 seasonal camping rate (totaling \$1,650) via Roll Call [02:16:01](#).
 - *Event Fees:* Approved increasing small event fees to \$50, large events to \$150, and a refundable security deposit of \$100 [02:20:11](#).
 - *Non-Motorized Watercraft Fees:* Approved daily rate of \$10 and annual rate of \$50 [02:22:38](#).
 - *Beach Fees:* Approved matching Twining Pool tier structure (\$2 for ages 0-2, \$4 for ages 3-12, \$5 for ages 13+) [02:25:50](#).
 - *Bank Fishing Fees:* Approved daily rate of \$5 and annual rate of \$25 [02:29:15](#).
 - *Daily Rentals (Primitive, Campsites, Cabins, Shelters):* Approved primitive camping at \$17, campsites at \$50, daily cabins at \$100, shelters at \$58, community cabins at \$75, and a \$100 security deposit for shelters/cabins [02:37:55](#).
 - *Golf Cart Pass Fees:* Approved abandoning daily cart rates and mandating a flat annual pass of \$100 for all carts brought into the campground [02:41:36](#).
- [02:41:09](#) **Septic System & Health Violations / Lease Non-Renewals (New Business)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members / Misty Reigns.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Addressed estimated costs (\$30,000 to \$100,000) for updating the Prairie Creek septic system to a compliant pump-and-haul system.

- Discussed legal rules adopted two months prior regarding non-renewal of leases for campers cited in IDOH health inspections. The board debated zero-tolerance versus establishing a fair appeals process, acknowledging that non-renewal letters must be sent while an appeal structure is formulated.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Discussion only; no formal vote taken.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General floor comments from residents during forum periods) - **00:09:07 Caleb Schwarz:** Spoke on community advocacy, grants, and support letters for the Westside Skate Park graffiti wall. - **00:28:42 Zion Strong:** Addressed the board regarding the Heekin Park basketball tournament, youth leagues, and the proposed Marwan Strong Park. - **00:34:43 Devon Mitchell:** Spoke regarding the JLG Memorial Walk 5K for suicide prevention. - **00:39:42 Kyle Freeman:** Presented the Prairie Creek Catfish Club tournament and raised concerns regarding the availability of bank fishing access. - **01:03:35 Charlie Moore (Friends of Prairie Creek):** Discussed campground kids' events ("Freddy the Fish" hunt), suggested on-site pontoon boat storage fees, and commented on park gate functionality and speed bumps. - **01:45:23 Keith Addison (Commodore, Muncie Sailing Club):** Explained sailing club maintenance efforts, private ramp usage, and argued against increasing sailboat slip fees disproportionately. - **01:50:01 & 02:05:15 Mike Foster (Campground Resident):** Commented on electrical cost burdens, fee comparisons with private campgrounds (Cozy Campground), and septic dump fee concerns. - **02:13:04 Nathan Buck (Campground Resident):** Discussed challenges of coordinating with utility companies for electrical grid upgrades. - **02:34:35 Mike Foster:** Offered additional comments on RV dump usage and transient camper impact on park infrastructure.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Notice of upcoming October board meeting (scheduled the day after the GFBF pre-grant meeting) **01:11:19**.
 - Future agenda items requested include discussion regarding the Prairie Creek office building utility costs and usage **03:05:32**.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded with closing remarks and expressions of appreciation **03:08:58**. *(Exact official adjournment timestamp/time not explicitly stated in transcript text).*